

Ruoyu Wen - CV

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PhD Candidate in Product Design · Game Designer · HCI Researcher  Christchurch, New Zealand | 
ruoyu.wen.game@gmail.com Google Scholar | LinkedIn | Portfolio

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I bridge theoretical research and practical game development across cultures, with a focus on **Human-Agent Interaction**, **Virtual Reality (VR)**, and **Alternate Reality Games (ARGs)**. My objective is to create meaningful connections, foster cultural understanding, and cultivate inclusive experiences for diverse global audiences. *
Core Expertise: Game Design, Academic Research, Player Psychology, Immersive Entertainment (XR/VR), Conversational AI, Cross-cultural Studies. * **Languages:** English, Chinese (Native).

EDUCATION

University of Canterbury, New Zealand | Christchurch, NZ *PhD in Product Design (HIT Lab NZ)* | 2023 – 2026 *
Focus: Human-Agent Interaction, VR, ARGs, and player motivation leveraging Self-Determination Theory. Mixed-method research.

Uppsala University, Sweden | Uppsala, SE *Master of Art in Game Design* | 2021 – 2023 * **Focus:** Interactive Narrative, Player Psychology, User Experience Design, and Game Design Theory.

Huazhong University of Science and Technology, China | Wuhan, CN *Bachelor of Arts/Science in Communication Studies* | 2016 – 2021 * **Focus:** Digital Media, Social Media, Human-Computer Interaction Fundamentals, and Digital Culture.

EXPERIENCE

Visiting PhD Student | *University of Augsburg, Chair for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence* | Augsburg, DE Apr 2026 – Present * Conducting collaborative research on human-centered AI, intelligent user interfaces, and human-agent interaction.

Lead AI Game Designer | *MICROFEEL* | Remote Oct 2024 – Present * Led team development, implementing end-to-end generation from natural language input to game stories, gameplay mechanics, and NPCs.

Visiting PhD Student | *KAIST (Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology)* | Daejeon, KR Oct 2025 * Conducted collaborative research on Extended Reality (XR) and Human-Computer Interaction at the GSCT UVR Lab.

Teaching Assistant | *University of Canterbury* | Christchurch, NZ Jul 2025 – Oct 2025 * TA for *Computation for Games*, supporting undergraduates in game development, programming, and computational foundations.

PhD Researcher / Research Assistant | *University of Canterbury (HIT Lab NZ)* | Christchurch, NZ 2023 – Present * Conducted research in VR, Human-Agent interaction, and conversational AI. * Participated in data collection, experiment design, and quantitative/qualitative analyses. * Published works in leading HCI/Gaming conferences such as CHI, OzCHI, DiGRA, and SIGGRAPH Asia.

Research Intern | *NeXT SCENE (Immersive Entertainment)* | Shanghai, CN Apr 2022 – May 2022 * Investigated narrative-driven entertainment formats (Jubenshika/Escape Rooms) and player engagement in social gaming experiences. * Developed frameworks for evaluating immersive experience design.

Strategy Investor Intern | *Huya (NASDAQ: HUYA)* | Guangzhou, CN Feb 2021 – Jun 2021 * Conducted market research and analyzed investment opportunities in the gaming and entertainment tech sectors for a major live-streaming platform.

Game Designer | *Chengdu ChuangLeHui (JOY NOVA)* | Sichuan, CN Mar 2020 – May 2020 * Contributed to mobile game concept development, gameplay mechanics design, and playtesting for “Champion of the Fields”.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Can AI Prompt Humans? Multimodal Agents Prompt Players’ Game Actions and Show Consequences to Raise Sustainability Awareness. *CHI 2025*.
- Exploring User Preferences for Museum Guides: The Role of Chatbots in Shaping Interactive Experiences. *CHI 2025 Extended Abstracts*.
- GenLinguaScope: Enabling User-Defined VR Scenarios for Communicative Language Practice. *ISMAR 2025 Adjunct*.
- Large Language Models for Automatic Detection of Sensitive Topics. *OzCHI 2024*.
- An Exploratory Study on AI-driven Visualisation Techniques for Decision Making in Extended Reality. *OzCHI 2024*.
- Sketchar: Supporting Character Design and Illustration Prototyping Using Generative AI. *CHI Play 2024*.
- Motivational Landscapes of ARG Players: A Self-Determination Theory Perspective. *DiGRA 2024*.
- Virtual Triplets: Mixed Modal Synchronous and Asynchronous Collaboration with Human-Agent Interaction in VR. *CHI 2024 Extended Abstracts*.
- I Light U Up: Exploring a New Emergent Narrative Paradigm through Light and Generative AI. *SIGGRAPH Asia 2024 Art Papers*.
- Listen to the Sword: Using Breathing and Spatial Audio for Wuxia Games. *CHI 2024 Extended Abstracts*.
- The Impact of Alternate Reality Games on Environmental Cognition for University Freshmen. *HCI International 2024*.
- Player Category Research on Murder Mystery Games. *International Journal of Role-Playing 2023*.
- The Chinese Hotpot of Larp. *Knutpunkt 2022 Magazine*.